

Word family: **form / forms / formed / forming / formation / formative / reform / reformulate**

Base word: form

Part of speech: **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **form** (n.) — 形式；形態；表格；班級 / 年級；體能 / 狀態

* **form** (v.) — 形成；組成；建立

* **formation** (n.) — 形成；組成；編隊 / 隊形

* **formative** (adj.) — 形成中的；對發展有重要影響的

* **reform** (v./n.) — 改革；改良

* **re-form** (v.) — 再次形成

* **reformulate** (v.) — 重新表述 / 重新配方

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **Form One / Form Six**

* **form a group / committee**

* **form an opinion**

* **form a habit**

* **take form**

* **take the form of**

* **in the form of**

* **form part of**

* **fill in / fill out a form**

* **application form**

* **tax form**

* **good / bad form**

* **in form / out of form**

* **physical form**

* **formation**

* **formative years**

Meaning in this passage

> He taught at the government secondary school I attended from **Form One to Form Six**.

Here, **Form** means:

a school year or grade level, especially in British and Hong Kong usage — 年級；中學級別

In Hong Kong English:

* **Form One** = 中一

* **Form Six** = 中六

中文翻譯：

他在我由**中一讀到中六**的那間官立中學任教。

So here:

Form One to Form Six = 中一至中六

1. **Form One / Form Six (年級) — 中一 / 中六**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I attended the school from **Form One to Form Six**.

我由**中一讀到中六**都在那間學校就讀。

Practice 2

> She is currently in **Form Three**.

她目前就讀**中三**。

Practice 3

> I first met him when I was in **Form Two**.

我第一次認識他時正在讀**中二**。

MCQ-ready definition:

Form + number = 英式或香港教育制度中表示中學年級的方式

2. **form (形式 ; 方式) — 形式 ; 方式**

A major abstract noun sense.

Practice 1

> Online learning is one **form of education**.

網上學習是教育的一種**形式**。

Practice 2

> Exercise is a useful **form of stress relief**.

運動是一種很有用的**紓壓方式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form = 某事存在、出現或進行的一種特定方式或類型

3. **a form of something — 某事物的一種形式 / 類型**

Practice 1

> Poetry is a **form of literature**.

詩歌是文學的一種**形式**。

Practice 2

> This behaviour may be a **form of protest**.

這種行為可能是一種**抗議形式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a form of something = 某個更大類別之中的一種表現方式或類型

4. **in the form of — 以……形式**

Practice 1

> The prize came **in the form of a scholarship**.

獎勵是**以獎學金的形式**提供的。

Practice 2

> Help arrived **in the form of food and medicine**.

援助**以食物和藥物的形式**送到。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in the form of X = 以 X 這種方式、外觀或類型出現****

5. ****take the form of — 採取……形式****

Practice 1

> The discussion ****took the form of a debate****.

討論**以辯論的形式進行**。

Practice 2

> The assessment ****takes the form of a written test****.

評核**採用筆試形式**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****take the form of X = 以 X 的形式出現或進行****

6. ****form (形狀 ; 外形) — 形態 ; 外形 ; 輪廓****

Practice 1

> The sculpture has an unusual ****form****.

這件雕塑有一個很特別的****形態****。

Practice 2

> We could just make out a dark ****form**** in the distance.

我們勉強看見遠處有一個黑暗的****人影 / 輪廓****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form = 某人或物的外在形狀、輪廓或整體形態****

7. ****human form — 人形 ; 人體形態****

Practice 1

> The artist studied the **human form**.

那位藝術家研究**人體形態**。

Practice 2

> A shadowy **human form** appeared at the door.

門口出現了一個模糊的**人形**。

MCQ-ready definition:

human form = 人的身體外形或輪廓

8. **form (表格) — 表格**

A very important practical sense.

Practice 1

> Please fill in this **form**.

請填寫這份**表格**。

Practice 2

> I submitted the application **form** yesterday.

我昨天遞交了申請**表格**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form = 有固定欄位、供人填寫資料的文件

9. **application form — 申請表**

Practice 1

> You need to complete an **application form**.

你需要填寫一份**申請表**。

Practice 2

> The **application form** is available online.

申請表可以在網上取得。

MCQ-ready definition:

application form = 用來申請學校、工作、服務等的正式表格

10. **form (語法形式) — 詞形 ; 形式**

A common language-learning sense.

Practice 1

> “Went” is the past **form** of “go.”

went 是 **go** 的過去式**形式**。

Practice 2

> Use the correct verb **form**.

請使用正確的動詞**形式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form = 一個字、動詞或語言單位在特定文法功能下所呈現的形式

11. **form (藝術 / 文學形式) — 體裁 ; 形式**

Practice 1

> The novel is a popular literary **form**.

小說是一種流行的文學**形式**。

Practice 2

> Dance is an expressive art **form**.

舞蹈是一種富表達力的藝術**形式**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form = 藝術、文學或表達活動的一種特定類型或結構****

12. ****form (身體狀態 / 競技狀態) — 狀態 ; 表現****

A major sports/performance sense.

Practice 1

> The player is in excellent ****form****.

那名球員目前****狀態極佳****。

Practice 2

> She has been out of ****form**** recently.

她最近一直****狀態不佳****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form = 某人在一段時間內的身體狀態或表現水平****

13. ****in good form — 狀態良好 ; 表現出色****

Practice 1

> The team is in ****good form**** this season.

這支球隊今季****狀態很好****。

Practice 2

> He looked in ****good form**** during training.

他在訓練時看起來****狀態很好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in good form = 身體或競技表現處於良好狀態****

14. **out of form — 狀態不佳**

Practice 1

> The striker has been **out of form** for weeks.

那名前鋒已經幾星期**狀態不佳**。

Practice 2

> I felt completely **out of form** today.

我今天感覺自己完全**不在狀態**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****out of form = 表現或身體狀態低於平時水平****

15. **form (禮儀 / 合宜行為) — 禮節 ; 合宜做法**

Usually in expressions like **good form / bad form**.

Practice 1

> It is considered **bad form** to interrupt someone repeatedly.

不斷打斷別人被視為**很失禮 / 不合禮節**。

Practice 2

> Thanking the host is simply **good form**.

向主人道謝是基本的**禮貌做法**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****good/bad form = 符合 / 不符合社交禮儀或公認合宜行為的做法****

16. **form (verb : 形成) — 形成 ; 產生**

Practice 1

> Clouds began to **form** over the hills.

山丘上空開始**形成雲層**。

Practice 2

> Ice **formed** on the surface of the lake.

湖面上**形成了冰層**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form = 某物逐漸產生、出現或取得明確形態

17. **form something (組成 ; 建立) — 組成 ; 成立**

Practice 1

> They **formed a committee**.

他們**成立了一個委員會**。

Practice 2

> The students **formed small groups**.

學生們**組成了小組**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form something = 把人或事物組織起來，建立成一個新的整體

18. **form a relationship / friendship — 建立關係 / 友誼**

Practice 1

> The children quickly **formed friendships**.

孩子們很快便**建立了友誼**。

Practice 2

> She **formed a close relationship** with her teacher.

她和老師**建立了親密關係**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form a relationship/friendship = 逐漸建立起人際連繫****

19. ****form an opinion / impression — 形成意見 / 印象****

Practice 1

> Don't ****form an opinion**** too quickly.

不要太快****形成看法****。

Practice 2

> I ****formed a good impression**** of him.

我對他****形成了很好的印象****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form an opinion/impression = 經過觀察或思考後逐漸產生某種看法或印象****

20. ****form an idea / plan — 形成構思 / 計劃****

Practice 1

> An idea began to ****form in her mind****.

她腦海裏開始****形成一個想法****。

Practice 2

> We gradually ****formed a plan****.

我們逐漸****構思出一個計劃****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form an idea/plan = 逐漸產生並組織出清晰的想法或方案****

21. ****form a habit — 養成習慣****

Practice 1

> It takes time to **form a new habit**.

養成新習慣需要時間。

Practice 2

> Children can **form habits** very quickly.

孩子可以很快**養成習慣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form a habit = 透過重複行為逐漸建立固定習慣

22. **form part of something** — 構成.....的一部分

Practice 1

> These exercises **form part of the course**.

這些練習**構成課程的一部分**。

Practice 2

> The islands **form part of a larger chain**.

這些島嶼**構成較大島鏈的一部分**。

MCQ-ready definition:

form part of something = 作為某個更大整體的一部分而存在

23. **form a line / queue / circle** — 排成隊伍 / 圓圈

Practice 1

> The students **formed a line** outside the classroom.

學生在課室外**排成一行**。

Practice 2

> We **formed a circle** around the table.

我們在桌子周圍**圍成一圈**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****form a line/circle = 以特定空間排列方式組成一個形狀****

24. ****formation (形成) — 形成 ; 生成****

Practice 1

> Scientists studied the ****formation of clouds****.

科學家研究雲的****形成****。

Practice 2

> The ****formation of ice**** can damage pipes.

冰的****形成****可能損壞水管。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****formation = 某物形成、產生或逐漸建立的過程****

25. ****formation (隊形 ; 編隊) — 隊形 ; 編隊****

A distinct domain extension.

Practice 1

> The planes flew in ****formation****.

飛機以****編隊****飛行。

Practice 2

> The team changed its ****formation**** in the second half.

球隊在下半場改變了****陣形****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****formation = 人、車輛、飛機或球員等按特定方式排列形成的隊形****

26. **formation (組成 ; 成立) — 組成 ; 建立**

Practice 1

> The **formation of the committee** took several weeks.

委員會的**成立**花了幾個星期。

Practice 2

> The agreement led to the **formation of a new group**.

該協議促成了一個新團體的**成立**。

MCQ-ready definition:

formation = 團體、制度或組織建立起來的過程

27. **formative — 對形成 / 發展有重要影響的**

Practice 1

> His school years were highly **formative**.

他的求學時期對他的成長有很大的**塑造作用**。

Practice 2

> That experience was **formative** for her career.

那段經歷對她的職業發展具有重要的**塑造作用**。

MCQ-ready definition:

formative = 對某人的性格、思想、能力或發展產生重要塑造作用的

28. **formative years — 性格 / 人生形成的重要時期**

Practice 1

> He spent his **formative years** in Hong Kong.

他的**成長關鍵時期**是在香港度過的。

Practice 2

> Experiences during the **formative years** can have lasting effects.

成長形成期的經歷可以帶來長遠影響。

MCQ-ready definition:

formative years = 對性格、思想和能力發展特別重要的成長階段

29. **reform (改革) — 改革 ; 改良**

Although morphologically related, **reform** is lexicalized enough to deserve separate treatment.

Practice 1

> The government plans to **reform the education system**.

政府計劃**改革教育制度**。

Practice 2

> The law needs major **reform**.

這項法律需要大幅**改革**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reform = 改變制度、法律或組織，使其運作得更好

30. **re-form (重新形成) — 再次形成**

Do not confuse this with **reform**.

Practice 1

> The group **re-formed** several years later.

幾年後，這個團體**重新組成**。

Practice 2

> The ice began to **re-form** overnight.

冰在晚上開始**重新形成**。

MCQ-ready definition:

re-form = 某物在分散、消失或解體後再次形成

Important distinction 1: **form vs shape**

form

can mean overall structure, type, or physical appearance.

shape

more specifically emphasizes physical outline.

> the human **form**

人體形態

> a circular **shape**

圓形

Form is more abstract and broader.

Important distinction 2: **form vs type**

type

category.

form

way in which something appears or exists.

> a type of transport

一種交通工具類別

> a form of transport

一種交通方式

Often close, but **form** stresses manifestation or mode.

Important distinction 3: **form** vs **format**

form

structure/type.

format

specific arrangement or presentation.

> essay form

文章形式

> document format

文件格式

They are related but not interchangeable.

Important distinction 4: **form** vs **structure**

form

overall configuration or manifestation.

structure

how different parts are organized and connected.

> the form of a poem

詩的形式

> the structure of a building

建築結構

Important distinction 5: **form** vs **figure**

form

general outline/body shape.

figure

often specifically human body shape or visible person.

> a dark form in the distance

遠處一個模糊身影

> a tall figure

一個高大身影

Important distinction 6: **form** vs **form a group**

Noun

> a **form** of communication

一種溝通形式

Verb

> **form a group**

組成小組

This is a genuine noun–verb shift.

Important distinction 7: **form** vs **fill in a form**

Classic learner trap:

> **form** a group

形成 / 組成一個團體

VS

> fill in a **form**

填表格

Same spelling, very different lexical senses.

Important distinction 8: **Form One** vs form one

Capitalization matters in education terminology.

Form One

= 中一

form one group

= 組成一組

In the passage, **Form** is capitalized because it is part of the official year-level label.

Important distinction 9: **form an opinion** vs have an opinion

form an opinion

focuses on the process of developing the opinion.

have an opinion

focuses on possessing the opinion.

> I haven't **formed an opinion** yet.

我還未形成看法。

> I **have an opinion** about it.

我對這件事有看法。

Important distinction 10: **form a habit vs have a habit**

form a habit

養成習慣

have a habit

有某個習慣

Again:

* **form** = development

* **have** = existing state

Important distinction 11: **form vs create**

create

emphasizes bringing something new into existence.

form

often emphasizes gradual development or organization into a structure.

> create a company

創立公司

> form a committee

成立委員會

There is overlap, but **form** often emphasizes assembling parts/people into an organized whole.

Important distinction 12: **form vs establish**

form

can be natural, gradual, or organizational.

establish

usually more formal and intentional.

> Clouds **form** naturally.

雲自然形成。

> The organization was **established** in 1990.

該機構於1990年成立。

Important distinction 13: **form vs formation**

form

verb:

> clouds form

雲形成

noun:

> a form of art

藝術形式

formation

noun:

> cloud formation

雲的形成 / 雲層形態

Formation often refers to either the process or the resulting arrangement.

Important distinction 14: **formation = process vs arrangement**

Process

> the **formation of ice**

冰的形成

Arrangement

> fly in **formation**

編隊飛行

These should be taught separately because the Chinese translation and concept differ clearly.

Important distinction 15: **in form** vs **in good shape**

These overlap in sports/fitness contexts.

in form

performing well, especially recently.

in good shape

physically fit or in good condition.

An athlete can be physically fit but temporarily **out of form**.

Important distinction 16: **good form** vs **good form**

This expression can itself be ambiguous.

Sports/performance

> He is in **good form**.

他狀態很好。

Social behaviour

> It is **good form** to thank your host.

這是合乎禮節的做法。

Context determines the sense.

Important distinction 17: **formative vs formal**

These look similar but are unrelated in modern meaning.

formative

塑造發展的

formal

正式的

> formative experience

塑造人的經歷

> formal event

正式活動

Important distinction 18: **reform vs re-form**

Very important spelling distinction.

reform

= improve/change a system

> reform education

改革教育

re-form

= form again

> re-form the group

重新組成團體

The hyphen helps signal the difference.

Family-extension note

****Form**** is an excellent polysemy family because it has several genuinely distinct modern branches:

1. ****education level****

- * Form One

- * Form Six

2. ****type / manifestation****

- * a form of art

- * in the form of

- * take the form of

3. ****physical shape****

- * human form

- * a dark form

4. ****document****

- * application form

- * fill in a form

5. ****grammar / language****

- * verb form

6. ****performance****

- * in form

- * out of form

7. ****social convention****

- * good form

- * bad form

8. **verb: develop / create structure**

- * clouds form
- * form a group
- * form an opinion
- * form a habit

9. **formation**

- * process of forming
- * organized arrangement / team formation

10. **formative**

- * shaping future development

This is exactly the kind of ordinary-looking word that the scanning SOP warns us not to overlook.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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Form One	中一	school year
Form Six	中六	school year
form (type)	形式；方式	manifestation/type
a form of X	X 的一種形式	subtype
in the form of	以.....形式	manner of appearance
take the form of	採取.....形式	appear as
form (shape)	形態；外形	physical outline
human form	人體形態	human shape
form (document)	表格	document to complete
application form	申請表	application document
form (grammar)	詞形；形式	grammatical shape
art form	藝術形式	artistic type
form (performance)	狀態；表現	recent performance
in good form	狀態良好	performing well
out of form	狀態不佳	performing poorly
good/bad form	合乎 / 不合禮節	social convention
form (verb)	形成	come into existence
form a group	組成團體	organize whole
form a relationship	建立關係	develop relationship
form an opinion	形成看法	develop judgment
form a habit	養成習慣	develop habit
form part of	構成.....的一部分	constitute

form a line	排成一行	arrange physically	
formation	形成	process	
formation (arrangement)	隊形；編隊	organized arrangement	
formative	塑造發展的	shaping development	
formative years	成長關鍵時期	development period	
reform	改革	improve system	
re-form	重新形成	form again	

For your original sentence

> He taught at the government secondary school I attended from **Form One to Form Six**.

Here:

Form = 中學年級；級別

Specifically:

> **Form One = 中一**

> **Form Six = 中六**

So:

> **from Form One to Form Six = 由中一至中六**

This is a **Hong Kong/British-style education sense**, not the much more common general meanings such as **form = 形式**, **form = 表格**, or **form = 形成**.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他在我由**中一讀到中六**的那間官立中學任教。